Tones of Note

Music proposal – Lara & Marcello's wedding – 14 March 2021

Your wedding is an intimate reflection of you and as such requires musical and creative attention. To authentically convey that feeling to the guests sharing in this momentous day, your musical input is invaluable.

Over the next months, we'll be working with you on your wedding soundtrack. Building on our experience of what works and what doesn't, we'll guide you in the repertoire selection process from guest arrivals to closing song.

Most of the suggested acts below are open to learning new repertoire, so if you've got something specific in mind, let us know. While we'll try to our best to accommodate you, we'll also be honest when we feel something won't work musically or is not possible.

Guest arrivals: The simplest and most cost effective way of welcoming guests to your wedding is to have background music played through the PA. Depending on the type of ensemble booked for the Chuppah we could also include some live instrumental music to welcome guests to the Chuppah area.

Chuppah: Scott Haig Roberts on vocals and Nathan Sklair on guitar to perform selected songs for the Chuppah, including the Sheva Brachot. For the processionals, we can go traditional with well-known Hebrew songs such as Boi Kallah and Mi Adir or you have the option of contemporary folk songs like Follow the Sun and Better Together.

In addition to Scott and Nathan, we could also add a string quartet including 2 x violins, 1 x viola and 1 x cello. The addition of the strings also opens the repertoire up to include classical and contemporary songs performed instrumentally. These include options like Coldplay's Fix You and Sky Full of Stars, Symphony by Clean Bandit and many more.

Pre-drinks: Building on the emotion created at the Chuppah, this period allows guests to catch up with friends and family while taking in their surroundings. The music during this time should animate/enliven those conversations not interfere or compete with them.

There are three options for the pre-drinks section:

Option one: DJ + Saxophone

A DJ is a good alternative to a live performer for pre-drinks, with the music during this period setting the tone for the rest of the night. Musically speaking, DJs have a broader range of styles and songs to choose from, allowing them to take the music where the guests want it to go. Ultimately this set must be upbeat, featuring songs that appeal to the majority of your guests while also representing your musical preferences.

This is achieved by playing a mix of classics from soul, jazz, reggae and current popular music. To find out which songs from those genres most resonate, we've included a 90-minute sampler below. Please give it a listen and send us your feedback. We'll use that to curate the set.

Rus Nerwich - Pre-drinks Sampler

Option two: Jazz quartet

While guests enjoy pre-drinks, we suggest a jazz quartet including saxophone, double bass, piano and drums. The interplay between the different instrumentalists provides variety for guests whether they are actively listening or not. Providing a sophisticated soundtrack for uninterrupted conversation, this set is mostly comprised easy-listening instrumental jazz.

For videos of the quartet's past performances, please see the following links:

Rus Nerwich quartet - Swing set

Rus Nerwich Quartet - St. Thomas

Option three: Ethan Florus band

Reinterpreting and performing a wide range of songs from Drake's Hot Line Bling to Alicia Key's If I Ain't Got You, Ethan Florus brings warmth and soul to his performances in a refreshing way. Ethan performs in a few musical configurations but given the number guests and function, we'd recommend a trio or quartet for this set.

Ethan Florus - Unaware [Allen Stone cover]

If you're Horahs are taking place in the same place as the pre-drinks, we'd recommend including a live option for the pre-drinks.

Horahs: Featuring Nathan Ambach on vocals, accompanied by band including saxophone, keys, bass and drums, this upbeat Horahs set is fun while being traditional. Regardless of which background your guests come from, the Horahs will get people on the dancefloor celebrating.

Starlight Band - Horahs – *Please note this ensemble features a large horn section.*

Starlight Band - Horahs (Tayla and Keegan)

Dinner:

Option One: Rus Nerwich to DJ background dinner set, facilitating flow around speeches.

Option Two: Jazz quartet including saxophone, keys, bass and drums to perform instrumental set with the option of a male or female vocalists on featured songs to build the tempo as we near the first dance and party to follow.

Jazz quartet - Bossa Nova Set

Benching: As mentioned previously, Scott and Nathan won't be open to performing the Benching unless they are booked for the Horahs too. From past experiences, we've booked Erez Shaked to perform the benching. He comes with his own keyboard accompaniment and offers some explanation of why we do benching which is great if some of your guests are unfamiliar with the tradition.

Dance set: Once the benching has been concluded, we'd normally have your first dance. Depending on the song, we can have the band play it live but most often we stick to the original played through the PA. Directly following your first dance, the Starlight Band featuring Nathan Ambach and Francesca Biancoli to kick off the dance party entertainment with an upbeat dance set, accompanied by band including saxophone, trumpet, guitar keys, bass and drums.

Here are some videos of the Starlight Band's past performances:

Instagram - Starlight Band - Rus and Nate

Instagram - Starlight Band - Rus and Nate (1)

Starlight Band - Happy

Francesca Biancoli - Volare

Dinner and dance: Taking into account your father's request, a big band is another option for during dinner and dance. I've included two size ensembles for this section. The first is a 13-piece band which includes 3 x vocalists, a 6-piece horn section and 4-piece rhythm section. The second is a 20-piece band which includes 3 x vocalists, a 13-piece horn section and 4-piece rhythm section. To get the most use from this band, we'd suggest playing from the start of dinner all the way through to the DJ set, building the tempo over the course of this period with a mix of instrumental, crooner-style tracks and of course upbeat tracks that will get everyone on the dancefloor regardless of age or background.

If we go in this direction, we can also potentially make use of the horns for this section during the Horahs set, coming closer to the reference video for the Horahs set included above.

Party: Straight from the band's last song, we transition into the party set which will feature Nathan as the DJ. Nathan launched the nightlife series: The Love Below as 'Your Monthly Rendezvous with Soul' in 2006 in his hometown of Antwerp, where he is still the resident DJ + promoter of funky music worldwide!

He's DJ'd alongside Mark Ronson at the WMC in Miami and played at the Love Below with DJ Jazzy Jeff (The Fresh Prince), DJ Premier, DJ Maseo (De La Soul), and DJ Rashida – the official tour DJ of Prince and Bruno Mars and DJ'd sets in clubs and events around Europe, America, Asia, Africa and the Middle East.

His Spotify playlists and online mixtapes represent his funky style, championing soulful music with great grooves and party hooks. For over 20 years, N8N has been rocking the business from BBQs to Bar-Mitzvahs!

N8N - The DJ Side of the Story